

## **Assignment-2**

### **Section-1**

#### **Question-1:**

##### **History of Twitter:**

Twitter started in 2005. It started from the offices of dying podcasting company called Odeo, which was run by three members: Evan Williams, Noah Glass, and Biz Stone. In the beginning, due to the arrival of Apple's new podcasting services, which were better than Odeo, Odeo started to feel that their success will be doomed, so it asked its employees to come up with new and creative ideas. Then Jack Dorsey, who worked as a web designer, gave the idea of an SMS-based communication platform that would allow users to send "status" updates to their friends. It was initially called "Twtr". Then, later it came to be known as "Twitter" referring to the sound a bird makes. Dorsey was the first person to post a tweet. The tweet had a 140-character capacity which was the limit mobile carriers put on text messages. The limit continued as it started on web platform. Twitter had a slow start and was mainly used by its employees. In August 2006, San Francisco was shocked by a small earthquake and that's when people realized that twitter can also be used as a platform to spread information.

#### **Question-2:**

Yes, all the points mentioned in the first video are almost accurate because all the points are mentioned from the past which is the history of "Twitter". Some more about the past of twitter relating its competition with Facebook and Instagram when they took place because arrival of new platforms should also be compared. And secondly, the big change in Twitter's changing of name and logo to X and the consequences and reactions of people it had.

#### **Question-3:**

##### **Twitter's Impact on Communication:**

Twitter has a profound impact on communication:

- The 140-character limit forces the user to post concise and relevant information and be to the point.
- The twitter provides real time update and keeps its users up to date.
- The hashtags let people know the going on trends and help them get familiar with the popular discussions going on.
- Twitter connects people around the world facilitating global communication.
- Twitter has played a great role in political and social movements providing a platform for a better communication in this regard and for the social movements and protests going on.

**Prompt for Question-3:** What does this means: How do you think Twitter changed the paradigm of online communication?

## **Section-1**

### **Question-1:**

#### **Perspective of Video-2:**

In the video 2, The reporter has asked the basic questions raised by people after the arrival of twitter for example, the purpose of threads, its extra features which twitter lacked, the similarity in them, the opinion for its future, etc.

Basically, the journalist tells the reporter that the new social media platform, “Threads”, hit the sky right after its launch because of its new interface which is better for communication. It’s also good for business because when something new starts people are curious about it so there are tons of users here so, threads will help facilitate boost business.

### **Question-2:**

No, I don’t agree with the guest’s opinion because when she was asked about the extra features of threads, she just mentioned some very small changes that occurred. In my opinion, most of these things were already on twitter and do not much affect the connectivity. Moreover, she discusses about all the drama going on in twitter. That’s because threads is a new platform so such type of things aren’t happening but as time passes the same will start happening on threads too. I think that she is biased because she is just discussing the features of threads in different wordings again and again.

### **Question-3:**

#### **Gist of the Message in Video-3:**

In video 3, the reporter is explaining some of the features of the new social media app “Threads”. She also tells the differences and similarities between Twitter and Threads. She says that threads bring new trend, new posts, new content, etc. Although threads have some similarities with twitter, still it is new to the users. Its user interface is very similar to Instagram, and it is also linked with Instagram account. Threads has the fastest popularity growing rate. Elon Musk threatened Zuckerberg for copying twitter, but this isn’t the first time happening. Instagram also started reels in 2020 as a competition to TikTok. Elon Musk also had imposed so many restrictions on twitter so threads will be preferred by more users soon.

### **Question-4:**

#### **Differences:**

- Threads offers 500 characters on a single post (Thread) while twitter offers only 280 characters on a tweet. [00:01:25]
- While twitter uses hashtags (#) in most of the tweets, threads doesn’t use hashtags. [00:01:40]

- Twitter allows users to search for a specific text, meanwhile threads lacks this feature. [00:01:45]

**Similarities:**

- Threads is also a microblogging app just like twitter because both apps allow the user to post pictures along with some text for conversation, etc. [00:00:09]
- Threads' features are quite similar to twitter except the fact that they changed the name from Tweets to 'Threads', Retweets to 'Reposts', etc. [00:01:18]

**Launching of Threads:**

In my opinion, launching threads was not a good decision because it was just like copying another social media platform and adding some extra features in it. Twitter should have been modified to make it better so the users would not spread to different social media apps. Also having more apps will consume more of their time.

**Question-5:**

In video 2, the tone of the guest speaker is variable and changes according to the circumstances. At first when she is asked about her opinion, she happily expresses it. Then when she is told to explain the differences between twitter and threads, she emphasizes the small factors which don't really matter. Then when something interesting is discussed, her voice and tone also becomes more emphasizing on the facts that were discussed. Her tone seems to be in favour of Threads because when something is going against Threads, she tries to cover it while, she is smooth and calm when in favour of Threads.

In video 3, the tone of the speaker is neutral towards both the apps, twitter, and threads. Her facial expressions can be observed at different points in the video. When something questioning comes, she adjusts her eyebrows according to it. Other non-verbal cues such as tone and body language are showing neutral behavior towards both rivals.

**Section-3****Question-1:****Maintaining Threads' Hype:**

Threads hasn't been able to uphold its original hype because when threads was launched people were so curious about it and they were so excited for a whole new social media platform, so they immediately installed it and signed up. But after some time of using it, they found it somehow similar to twitter, so they reduced their usage time. Also, the fact that Threads had a count for the users who were joining Threads and the first one to come got the smaller number, so this got people competition between people that who gets the smaller number and who is going to be the person to join threads earlier.

Threads also couldn't maintain its initial excitement because of the factor of privacy concerns because Threads was accessing to so much user personal information which didn't have any concern with the app, like sharing locations with close friends, health fitness, etc.

Threads also didn't put much effort in marketing which is also a reason for its downfall.

### **Threads' Downfall:**

There are several reasons for its fall from its grace, but the major factors are the following:

Threads was launched with a similar interface to Instagram and as Mark Zuckerberg said it wasn't made for political or hard news which is the main thing on twitter and the rest of its purpose, which is communication, can already be found on Instagram. So, Threads failed to clarify its purpose to be launched as a separate app.

So that's the reason Threads failed to compete with the current social media platforms because the other applications already had the features which Threads presented.

### **References:**

Google Bard:

**Prompt:** What do you think is the biggest reason for the social media app Threads' fall from grace?